and layout configuration in centralized files. In the next section you'll see how to wield these files to clean up your templates.

17.4.4 Running code on every view with _ViewStart and _ViewImports

Due to the nature of views, you'll inevitably find yourself writing certain things repeatedly. If all your views use the same layout, adding the following code to the top of every page feels a little redundant:

```
@{
    Layout = "_Layout";
}
```

Similarly, if you find you need to reference objects from a different namespace in your Razor views, then having to add `@using WebApplication1.Models` to the top of every page can get to be a chore. Fortunately, ASP.NET Core includes two mechanisms for handling these common tasks: _ViewImports.cshtml and _ViewStart.cshtml.

Importing common directives with _ViewImports

The _ViewImports.cshtml file contains directives that are inserted at the top of every Razor view. This can include things like the `@using` and `@model` statements that you've already seen—basically any Razor directive. For example, to avoid adding a `@using` statement to every view, you can include it in _ViewImports.cshtml instead of in your Razor Pages, as shown in the following listing.

Listing 17.14 A typical _ViewImports.cshtml file importing additional namespaces